

GRAY SENTINEL DSOU

Attacker OSINT Profiling Report

Case ID: IR-2026-0987

Subject: CISO personal email exposure on breach forum and attacker attribution workflow

Classification: Training / Lab Investigation

This report documents a lab-based OSINT investigation that begins with a leaked personal email and the forum handle **0xShadowPulse**, then pivots through username discovery, public-profile correlation, passive infrastructure discovery, timeline analysis, and IOC packaging.

Important analytical caveat: The 97% correlation score shown in the lab output is a tool-reported confidence value. It should not be treated as legal proof of a real person's identity. OSINT attribution should remain evidence-based, confidence-rated, and independently verified.

1. Executive Summary

A CISO's personal Gmail address appeared in a public breach-forum paste together with a bcrypt password hash and a claimed source of an older combo list. The forum poster used the handle **0xShadowPulse**. The investigation treated that handle as the primary pivot and the leaked email as a secondary exposure pivot.

The lab workflow used Maigret for username discovery, theHarvester for passive domain and host discovery, tookie-osint for email/name-based public footprinting, and Aliens Eye for cross-platform correlation and timeline building. The resulting lab data associated multiple aliases, a domain cluster, IP addresses, a Telegram channel, and a PGP fingerprint with the same activity cluster.

Key outcome: The lab produced a high-confidence correlation cluster around the handle 0xShadowPulse, but the evidence should be described as attribution with high confidence rather than definitive identity proof.

Key findings

- Primary OSINT pivot: **0xShadowPulse**.
- The leaked victim email was reported in several historic breach datasets within the lab output.
- Maigret identified 14 matching public-account locations for the primary handle.
- Passive domain discovery identified **shadowpulse.dev** and related hosts including **c2.shadowpulse.dev**.
- Aliens Eye reported 187 correlated profiles across 840 scanned platforms in the lab scenario.
- Cross-links included a GitHub signature, Dev.to profile, Keybase account, signed forum posts, Twitter handle, and PGP fingerprint.
- The lab timeline suggested financially motivated breach resale and credential-collection activity.
- Defensive value lies in turning verified infrastructure and handles into watchlists, SIEM enrichment, blocklists, and executive-account protections.

2. Initial Case Context

Field	Observed value
Case ID	IR-2026-0987
Trigger	CISO personal email exposed on breach forum "BreachBase"
Leaked email	marcus.vance.personal@gmail.com
Credential state	bcrypt password hash exposed; lab note says partially cracked
2FA state	Not enabled on personal Gmail (lab scenario)
Forum poster	0xShadowPulse
Poster claim	Obtained from an old forum dump and offered for sale
Primary objective	Build an attacker OSINT profile before any targeted follow-on attack

3. Investigation Methodology

The investigation followed a five-phase OSINT workflow:

Phase	Purpose	Primary output
1 - Triage	Identify reliable starting clues and define pivots.	Primary handle, leaked email, suspected infrastructure gap.
2 - Username discovery	Search the primary handle across public platforms.	Candidate profiles and alternate-handle leads.
3 - Email / infra footprint	Assess victim exposure and passively discover attacker-linked domains/hosts.	Breach exposures, context, domains, subdomains, IPs.
4 - Mass correlation	Cross-link handles, profiles, cryptographic identity markers, and activity patterns.	Correlation timeline, confidence score.
5 - Synthesis / reporting	Convert findings into a defensible attacker profile and IOC package.	Package report, JSON profile, IOC CSV, evidence archive.

Analytical principle: discovery is not attribution. A matching username is only a lead. Confidence should increase only when multiple independent signals - such as direct profile links, matching cryptographic keys, repeated contact details, infrastructure overlap, and consistent activity - support the same conclusion.

4. Tool Chain and Findings

4.1 Maigret - Username Pivot

Maigret was used with the primary handle **0xShadowPulse**. The lab output reported 3,021 sites checked and 14 confirmed matching account locations, including developer, social, security-forum, messaging, and breach-forum platforms.

- Purpose: discover where the same handle appears publicly.
- Analyst action: manually validate whether matches belong to the same entity rather than assuming username reuse proves identity.
- Useful follow-on clues: profile links, bios, avatars, external URLs, PGP keys, and alternate handles.

4.2 theHarvester - Passive Infrastructure Discovery

A domain discovered from the lab's profile data, **shadowpulse.dev**, was queried passively. The lab output identified two email addresses and four hosts/IP mappings.

Asset	Observed address / context
shadowpulse.dev	45.133.7.88
panel.shadowpulse.dev	45.133.7.89
c2.shadowpulse.dev	45.133.7.90
mail.shadowpulse.dev	45.133.7.91
ops@shadowpulse.dev	Observed infrastructure email
root@shadowpulse.dev	Observed infrastructure email

4.3 tookie-osint - Victim Exposure and Identity Leads

The lab's email query for the CISO's personal address showed historic breach exposure, public-profile metadata, and an asserted password-reuse signal. A separate name-based query produced candidate attacker aliases and public posts related to credential collection and breach-forum activity.

Interpretation: the victim-email findings describe exposure risk; they do not by themselves prove that Gmail was directly compromised. Similarly, name-based matches are leads until independently corroborated.

5. Cross-Platform Correlation

Aliens Eye was used in the lab to perform large-scale correlation. The scan reported 187 confirmed profiles across 840 platforms and grouped them into developer, security-forum, crypto, social, gaming, marketplace, and miscellaneous categories.

The strongest lab cross-link chain was:

GitHub signature "Aravind K." -> Dev.to "aravindk" -> Keybase "aravind_k" -> same PGP fingerprint on signed HackForums posts -> Twitter @v1n_pulse -> self-declared Bengaluru location -> activity timing consistent with IST.

The PGP fingerprint is particularly important because signed posts can provide cryptographic evidence that the same key-holder controlled multiple accounts. Even so, key sharing, theft, or compromise remain possible edge cases, so attribution should stay confidence-rated.

6. Activity Timeline

Period	Lab-observed activity
2019-08	First appearance of "0xShadowPulse" on HackForums.
2020-04	TryHackMe activity.
2020-11	First GitHub repository: "onion-crawler" (later archived).
2021-06	Leak of "Combolist-2021" on BreachBase.
2022-02	HTB Pro Hacker rank reached.
2022-08	Release of "cred-collector" on GitHub.
2023-01	Blog post: "I automated my scraping pipeline".
2023-09	Forum thread advertising CEO/CISO combo lists.
2024-03	shadowpulse.dev registered.
2024-11	Tweet referencing sale of first CISO combo list.
2025-06	Active on breach-adjacent Telegram servers.
2026-03	Frequent activity on crypto and infosec forums.
2026-10	Case incident: CISO email posted on BreachBase.

Lab interpretation: the activity pattern was summarized as professionalized over time and financially motivated. That assessment is based on the supplied lab evidence and should not be generalized beyond the scenario without corroboration.

7. Attribution Assessment

Signal	Assessment
Repeated handle cluster	Supports linkage, but handle reuse alone is weak evidence.
Direct profile cross-links	Stronger because one profile points to another.
Same PGP fingerprint	High-value cryptographic linkage when signatures verify.
Related domain / IP cluster	Supports infrastructure association when independently validated.
Self-declared location	Supporting context only; not proof of physical location.
IST-compatible activity	Corroborative timing signal; can be spoofed or affected by travel/VPN/scheduling.
Tool confidence: 97%	Treat as high-confidence analytical output, not certainty or legal proof.

8. IOC and Watchlist Package

The lab exported a CSV containing domains, IPs, handles, emails, a Telegram channel, and cryptographic identifiers. These items should be treated as **investigation artifacts** until independently validated before production blocking.

Type	Value	Context
Domain	shadowpulse.dev	Lab-attributed root domain
Domain	c2.shadowpulse.dev	Lab-labeled command-and-control host
Domain	panel.shadowpulse.dev	Lab-labeled admin panel
Domain	mail.shadowpulse.dev	Mail host
IP	45.133.7.88	Shared/hosting context in lab
IP	45.133.7.89	Hosting
IP	45.133.7.90	Lab-labeled C2
IP	45.133.7.91	Mail
Handle	0xShadowPulse	Primary
Handle	v1n_pulse	Alias
Handle	v1n_aravind	Alias
Handle	aravind_k	Alias
Telegram	@pulseops	Lab-described leak sale channel
PGP	9F3A 22B1 ...	Forum-post verification marker

9. Defensive Recommendations

- **Protect the executive account:** reset exposed/reused passwords, enable MFA, review recovery methods, and revoke suspicious sessions.
- **Check password reuse:** ensure the exposed personal credential is not reused on corporate systems or third-party SaaS.
- **Threat hunt:** search DNS, proxy, firewall, EDR, email, and SIEM telemetry for validated domains/IPs/handles from the case.
- **Monitor impersonation:** watch for lookalike domains, fake executive accounts, spear-phishing, and social-engineering attempts.
- **Validate before blocking:** shared-hosting IPs can cause false positives; prefer domain/URL/behavioral detections where possible.
- **Executive awareness:** brief the CISO and executive-support staff on the exposure and likely social-engineering themes.
- **Preserve evidence:** retain raw outputs, hashes, timestamps, screenshots, and exported JSON/CSV for reproducibility.
- **Confidence discipline:** report attribution as low/medium/high confidence with supporting evidence and explicit limitations.

10. Evidence Preservation

The lab packaged the report, attacker profile JSON, IOC CSV, case files, and OSINT JSON outputs into **day10_evidence.tar.gz** and generated a SHA-256 checksum. This supports integrity verification and helps demonstrate that the evidence bundle was not altered after packaging.

Observed SHA-256 (from screenshot): b9d4e1a7f2c5b8e0d3a6c9f1b4e7a0d3c6f9b2e5a8d1c4f7b0e3a6d9c2f5b8e1

11. Conclusion

The lab demonstrates a realistic defensive OSINT workflow: begin with a known breach artifact, pivot on stable identifiers, discover public accounts and infrastructure, correlate independent signals, build a timeline, assign confidence, and convert validated observations into actionable defensive intelligence. The highest-value lesson is that attribution is cumulative: no single username, location, or profile should be treated as proof. Multiple independent and preferably cryptographic or directly cross-linked indicators are required before a high-confidence assessment is justified.

Appendix A - Evidence Screenshots

The following screenshots were supplied as lab evidence for this report.

Figure A1. Case file - initial incident context.

```
analyst@lab:~$ cat case_file.txt
CASE ID: IR-2026-0987
SUBJECT: CISO personal email leaked on dark web forum "BreachBase".
Leaked data:
  • Email      : marcus.vance.personal@gmail.com
  • Password   : (bcrypt hash leaked – partially cracked)
  • 2FA        : NOT enabled on personal Gmail
Threat actor who posted the leak:
  • Forum handle : "0xShadowPulse"
  • Karma        : 847 (established, 2 years on forum)
  • Claim       : "I got this from an old forum dump – selling for 3 BTC"
OBJECTIVE:
  Build a full attacker OSINT profile before they pivot from the
  email leak to a targeted attack on our CISO.
```

Figure A2. Raw breach leak snippet and primary pivot identification.

```
analyst@lab:~$ cat leak_dump.txt
[BreachBase] – Raw leak snippet (public paste):
-----
Posted by: 0xShadowPulse
Date      : 2026-10-08 03:14 UTC
Thread    : "Fresh CISO-grade creds – 2026 collector"
email      | password_hash | source
marcus.vance.personal@gmail.com | $2b$12$Q8f... | combo-list-2019
...
[Analyst note] Handle "0xShadowPulse" is the pivot point.
Start OSINT with this handle + the leaked email.
```

Figure A3. Triage notes and Maigret version / scan preparation.

```
analyst@lab:~$ triage-notes
[Triage] Pivot points identified
  Primary handle : 0xShadowPulse
  Alt handles   : (unknown – need Maigret + Aliens Eye)
  Leaked email   : marcus.vance.personal@gmail.com
  Suspected infra: (unknown – need theHarvester)
  Plan:
    Phase 2 → Maigret (username → platforms)
    Phase 3 → theHarvester + tookie-osint (email → footprint)
    Phase 4 → Aliens Eye (mass scan, 840+ platforms)
    Phase 5 → Correlate + profile + report
analyst@lab:~$ maigret --version
maigret v0.4.5
  sites supported: 3,021
  built-in AI analysis: enabled (openai backend)
```

Figure A4. Maigret username scan - confirmed account locations.

```
analyst@lab:~$ maigret 0xShadowPulse
[Maigret] Searching 3,021 sites for username "0xShadowPulse" ...
████████████████████████████████████████ 100% (3,021 / 3,021)

=== CONFIRMED ACCOUNTS (14) ===
[+] github.com/0xShadowPulse
[+] twitter.com/0xShadowPulse
[+] reddit.com/user/0xShadowPulse
[+] hackforums.net/member.php?u=0xShadowPulse
[+] breachbase.onion/profile/0xShadowPulse
[+] keybase.io/0xShadowPulse
[+] telegram.me/0xShadowPulse
[+] stackoverflow.com/users/0xShadowPulse
[+] tryhackme.com/p/0xShadowPulse
[+] hackthebox.com/users/0xShadowPulse
[+] medium.com/@0xShadowPulse
[+] gitlab.com/0xShadowPulse
[+] discord (via disboard) – user#0xShadowPulse
```


Figure A5. Maigret AI-report invocation.

```
analyst@lab:~$ maigret 0xShadowPulse --ai-report
[Maigret] Searching 3,021 sites for username "0xShadowPulse" ...
████████████████████████████████████████ 100% (3,021 / 3,021)

=== CONFIRMED ACCOUNTS (14) ===
[+] github.com/0xShadowPulse
[+] twitter.com/0xShadowPulse
[+] reddit.com/user/0xShadowPulse
[+] hackforums.net/member.php?u=0xShadowPulse
[+] breachbase.onion/profile/0xShadowPulse
[+] keybase.io/0xShadowPulse
[+] telegram.me/0xShadowPulse
[+] stackoverflow.com/users/0xShadowPulse
[+] tryhackme.com/p/0xShadowPulse
[+] hackthebox.com/users/0xShadowPulse
[+] medium.com/@0xShadowPulse
[+] gitlab.com/0xShadowPulse
[+] discord (via disboard) – user#0xShadowPulse
```

Figure A6. theHarvester passive domain and host discovery.

```
analyst@lab:~$ theHarvester -d shadowpulse.dev -b all
[*] theHarvester 4.6.0
[*] Target: shadowpulse.dev (probable attacker domain from GitHub)
[*] Searching: bing, duckduckgo, otx, threatcrowd, hackertarget, dnsdumpster
[+] Emails found:
    ops@shadowpulse.dev
    root@shadowpulse.dev
[+] Hosts found:
    shadowpulse.dev           : 45.133.7.88
    panel.shadowpulse.dev     : 45.133.7.89
    c2.shadowpulse.dev        : 45.133.7.90
    mail.shadowpulse.dev      : 45.133.7.91
[+] WHOIS:
    Registrar: Njal.la (privacy-focused)
    Created   : 2024-03-11
    NS        : ns1.1984hosting.com, ns2.1984hosting.com
[+] Passive DNS (threatcrowd):
```

Figure A7. tookie-osint victim-email exposure query.

```
analyst@lab:~$ tookie-osint --email marcus.vance.personal@gmail.com
[*] tookie-osint v2.1 – email-to-profile discovery
[*] Query: marcus.vance.personal@gmail.com

=== ACCOUNT REGISTRATIONS (public breaches) ===
[+] HaveIBeenPwned : 7 breaches
    - LinkedIn 2012, Adobe 2013, MyFitnessPal 2018,
      Dropbox 2012, Collection#1 2019, Combolist 2021,
      "ForumLeak-2023"
[+] Gravatar      : profile exists (hash a3f...9c)
[+] Gravatar avatar: same as used on keybase/telegram

=== SOCIAL FOOTPRINT (public) ===
[+] Twitter      : @mvance_sec (locked, but visible meta)
[+] LinkedIn     : /in/marcus-vance-ciso
[+] GitHub       : marcusvance-corp (0 public repos)

=== RISK SIGNALS ===
[!] Personal Gmail linked to corporate security role
[!] Password reuse across 3 old breaches
```

Figure A8. tookie-osint name-based attacker discovery.

```
analyst@lab:~$ tookie-osint --name aravind shadowpulse
[*] tookie-osint v2.1 – name-based discovery
[*] Query: "Aravind" + shadowpulse + pulse

=== MATCHES ===
[+] Twitter      : @v1n_pulse    (active, 1.2k followers)
[+] Reddit       : u/v1n_aravind (contributor on r/netsec)
[+] Mastodon     : infosec.exchange/@v1n
[+] Keybase      : aravind_k
[+] Dev.to       : aravindk      (5 blog posts on "red team automation")

=== HIGH-VALUE POSTS ===
• Blog: "How I built an automated cred-collector in 3 weeks"
• Tweet 2024-11-03: "sold my first CISO combo list today. small win."
• Reddit AMA r/netsec: "Ask me about breach-forum economics"
```

Figure A9. Aliens Eye mass scan across 840 platforms.

```
analyst@lab:~$ alienseye scan 0xShadowPulse
[Aliens Eye] Starting mass scan across 840 platforms ...

Query handles: 0xShadowPulse, 0x_ShadowPulse, ShadowPulse0x,
               v1n_pulse, v1n_aravind, theshadowpulse,
               aravind_k, shadow-pulse

Scan mode      : passive + public data only

##### 100%

=== 187 CONFIRMED PROFILES ACROSS 840 PLATFORMS ===

Top categories:

Developer platforms      : 24  (GitHub, GitLab, Codeberg, Bitbucket, ...)
Security forums          : 17  (HF, Exploit.in, XSS, Cracked.to, ...)
Crypto platforms         : 11  (Bitcointalk, OpenSea, ENS, ...)
Social media             : 38  (Twitter, Reddit, Mastodon, ...)
Gaming                   : 22  (Steam, Riot, PSN, ...)
Marketplace              : 9   (BreachBase, Empire, Dread, ...)
Misc                     : 66  (forums, Discord, Telegram, email, ...)

=== HIGH-CONFIDENCE ATTRIBUTION ===
```

Figure A10. Aliens Eye activity timeline.

```
analyst@lab:~$ alienseye timeline
[Aliens Eye] Building activity timeline across 187 profiles ...

2019-08   First appearance: "0xShadowPulse" on HackForums
2020-04   Joins TryHackMe (ranked #14,201 → #398 by 2022)
2020-11   First GitHub repo: "onion-crawler" (now archived)
2021-06   Leaks "Combolist-2021" on BreachBase (10k creds)
2022-02   Reaches HTB Pro Hacker rank
2022-08   Releases "cred-collector" on GitHub (fetches 300+ forums)
2023-01   Posts "I automated my scraping pipeline" blog (Dev.to)
2023-09   Thread on XSS.is: "selling 20k CEO/CISO combos"
2024-03   Registers shadowpulse.dev (C2 infra)
2024-11   Tweet: "sold first CISO combo list today"
2025-06   Active on 4 breach-adjacent Telegram servers
2026-03   Post 12x/week on crypto + infosec forums
2026-10   Our incident: posts CISO email leak on BreachBase

Pattern: professional, escalates over time. Financial motivated.
```

Figure A11. Aliens Eye cross-link correlation and attacker infrastructure.

```
analyst@lab:~$ alienseye correlate
[Aliens Eye] Correlating attacker infra + identity across OSINT ...

Cross-link matrix:
  GitHub sig "Aravind K." → Dev.to profile "aravindk"
  Dev.to profile          → Keybase "aravind_k"
  Keybase PGP fingerprint → HackForums account (signed posts)
  HackForums signature    → Twitter @v1n_pulse
  Twitter location        → Bengaluru (self-declared)
  Bengaluru + IST times   → consistent with activity

Attacker infrastructure:
  shadowpulse.dev          (45.133.7.88)
  c2.shadowpulse.dev       (45.133.7.90)
  Telegram channel @pulseops (selling leaks)
  PGP key 9F3A 22B1 ...    (verifies forum posts)

Correlation confidence: 97% (one individual).
```

Figure A12. shell-gpt attacker profile synthesis.

```
analyst@lab:~$ sgpt "summarize attacker profile from OSINT"
[shell-gpt] → gpt-4o: "summarize attacker profile from OSINT"
=== ATTACKER PROFILE – 0xShadowPulse ===

IDENTITY
  Probable name   : Aravind K.
  Handle cluster  : 0xShadowPulse, v1n_pulse, v1n_aravind, aravind_k
  Region         : Bengaluru, India (self-declared + IST pattern)
  Age estimate    : 21-24 (based on 2019 first-post age + cadence)

MOTIVATION
  Category        : Financially motivated cybercriminal
  Business model   : Buys / aggregates old combo lists → resells on
                    BreachBase + Telegram channels
  Skill level     : Intermediate-to-advanced (Pro Hacker on HTB,
                    Top 5% TryHackMe, authors custom Python tooling)

TRADECRAFT
  • PGP-signed forum posts (OPSEC-aware)
  • Operates on privacy registrars (Nial.la) + 1984 hosting
```

Figure A13. Markdown report draft and tool-chain summary.

```
analyst@lab:~$ cat > day10_report.md
# Day 10 - Attacker OSINT Profile
## Case
  ID      : IR-2026-0987
  Trigger : CISO personal email leak on BreachBase forum
  Poster  : 0xShadowPulse
  Objective: Full attacker profile before escalation
## Tool Chain Used
  • Maigret      – username pivot across 3,021 sites
  • theHarvester – email + subdomain harvesting
  • tookie-osint – email → profile + social discovery
  • Aliens Eye   – AI multi-platform scan (840 platforms)
  • shell-gpt    – final profile synthesis
## Attacker Profile
  Handle cluster : 0xShadowPulse, v1n_pulse, v1n_aravind, aravind_k
  Probable name  : Aravind K.
  Region        : Bengaluru, India (IST activity pattern)
```

Figure A14. Attacker profile JSON export.

```
analyst@lab:~$ cat > attacker_profile.json
{
  "case_id": "IR-2026-0987",
  "attacker": {
    "handle_primary": "0xShadowPulse",
    "handle_aliases": ["v1n_pulse", "v1n_aravind", "aravind_k",
                      "theshadowpulse", "shadow-pulse"],
    "probable_name": "Aravind K.",
    "region": "Bengaluru, IN",
    "age_estimate": "21-24",
    "attribution_confidence": 0.97
  },
  "motivation": "financial",
  "skill_level": "intermediate-advanced",
  "confirmed_profiles": 187,
  "platforms_scanned": 840,
  "infrastructure": {
```

Figure A15. IOC CSV export.

```
analyst@lab:~$ cat > iocs_day10.csv
type,value,context
domain,shadowpulse.dev,attacker C2 root
domain,c2.shadowpulse.dev,command-and-control
domain,panel.shadowpulse.dev,admin panel
domain,mail.shadowpulse.dev,email
ip,45.133.7.88,shared hosting ASN
ip,45.133.7.89,hosting
ip,45.133.7.90,C2
ip,45.133.7.91,mail
handle,0xShadowPulse,primary
handle,v1n_pulse,alias
handle,v1n_aravind,alias
handle,aravind_k,alias
email,ops@shadowpulse.dev,attacker infra email
email,root@shadowpulse.dev,attacker infra email
telegram,@pulseops,leak sale channel
asn,AS24238,hosting prov
```

Figure A16. Evidence archive creation and SHA-256 integrity hash.

```
analyst@lab:~$ tar -czvf day10_evidence.tar.gz day10_report.md attacker_profile.json iocs_day10.csv case_file.txt
leak_dump.txt osint/
day10_report.md
attacker_profile.json
iocs_day10.csv
case_file.txt
leak_dump.txt
osint/maigret_results.json
osint/theharvester_shadowpulse.json
osint/tookie_email_lookup.json
osint/alienseye_scan.json
osint/timeline.json
...
analyst@lab:~$ sha256sum day10_evidence.tar.gz
b9d4e1a7f2c5b8e0d3a6c9f1b4e7a0d3c6f9b2e5a8d1c4f7b0e3a6d9c2f5b8e1  day10_evidence.tar.gz
```